

Step 1 — Claim a task

1

Browse tasks

Open the HAI task page. Filter by repo or language and click a task to preview the repo.

2

Evaluate the PR

Spend a few minutes reviewing the PR before claiming. Look at diff size, test coverage, and PR body quality.

3

Claim it

When you're confident the task is a good fit, claim it.

Before you claim

Spend a few minutes reviewing the PR:

- Diff size¹ — Is it a meaningful amount of code (not trivial, not overwhelming)?
- Test coverage² — Does the PR include or suggest tests you can turn into F2P?
- PR body³ — Is the problem and approach clear enough to build a good LLM prompt?

1. Target 25–500 SLOC of real logic changes

2. You'll need these for Step 5

3. This becomes your problem_statement in Step 6

If it looks overwhelming or trivially simple, skip it and pick another.

- **Too simple?** If the fix is trivially simple and making it more complex would over-complicate the code, claim it, flag it to the team, and submit with `NA` in the relevant fields.
- **Need to abandon?** Click **Exit** → **Abandon** to free the task for someone else.

Claiming locks the task

Only claim tasks you fully intend to complete.

Validity check after you claim

You'll only see the repo contents after claiming — git access kicks in at claim time. As soon as you have access, do a quick validity check before starting any docker work.

What to look for (all three must hold for the task to be valid):

- **Reasonable LOC of real logic** — in the 25–500 SLOC range. Lockfiles, generated code, vendor directories, and formatting-only changes don't count. Outside the range, the task is not useful for the benchmark.
- **A clear bug or missing feature on base** — there is a specific behavior on the base branch that's wrong or missing. If you can't identify the bug after reading the diff and the PR body, the task probably isn't valid.
- **Existing-solution actually fixes that bug** — the diff should match the bug you identified. If the PR description and the diff are about different things, flag it.

What's NOT a deal-breaker on its own:

- The original PR didn't add new tests. You can write your own F2P tests for a meaningful bug.
- The PR body is thin. A short body is fine if the diff makes the intent clear.

If all three hold, proceed to docker setup. If any one fails, flag as invalid (see troubleshooting §7) — do not try to compensate by improving the task yourself.

Time-box yourself

Cap the validity assessment at 15 minutes. If you can't decide in 15, flag and move on. Even 10 minutes of evaluation is real work — don't skip it because it feels short. The cost of a bad task spreading across review cycles is much worse than abandoning early.

For an example of what valid vs. invalid looks like at the diff level, see the [caching-layer-vs-lodash-upgrade](#) pair on the [What Makes a Good PR](#) page.

Flagging PRs

PRs can be flagged during both Environment Setup and Core Workflow. Always review the PR at claim time to decide if it should be flagged.

- Flag the PR if it is invalid — even if it was not flagged in an earlier stage.
- Do not proceed with golden-solution work if a PR is flagged.
- Do not spend more than 30 minutes evaluating whether to flag a PR.

Time accountability

Overclaiming time or ignoring flags may lead to removal from the project.

How to Explore & Claim a Task

Project Helix - How To Explore & Claim A Task

   9

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2 min 33 sec

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